Protocol “layers” and reference models

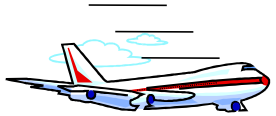
Networks are complex, with many “pieces”:

- hosts
- routers
- links of various media
- applications
- protocols
- hardware, software

Question: is there any hope of *organizing* structure of network?

- and/or our *discussion* of networks?

Example: organization of air travel



end-to-end transfer of person plus baggage

ticket (purchase)

baggage (check)

gates (load)

runway takeoff

airplane routing

ticket (complain)

baggage (claim)

gates (unload)

runway landing

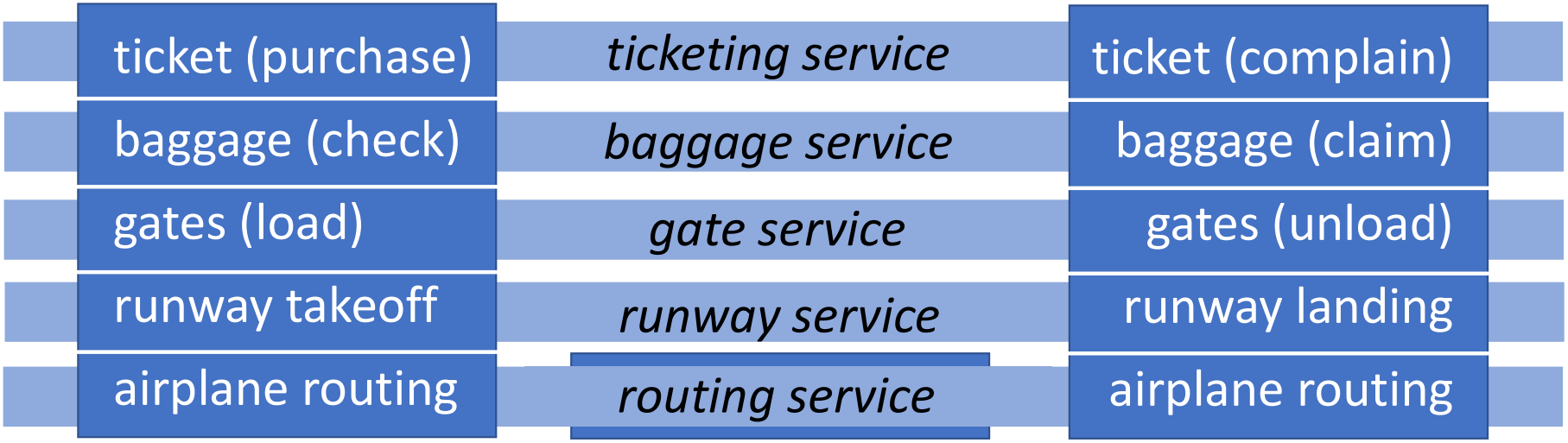
airplane routing

airplane routing

How would you *define/discuss* the *system* of airline travel?

- a series of steps, involving many services

Example: organization of air travel



layers: each layer implements a service

- via its own internal-layer actions
- relying on services provided by layer below

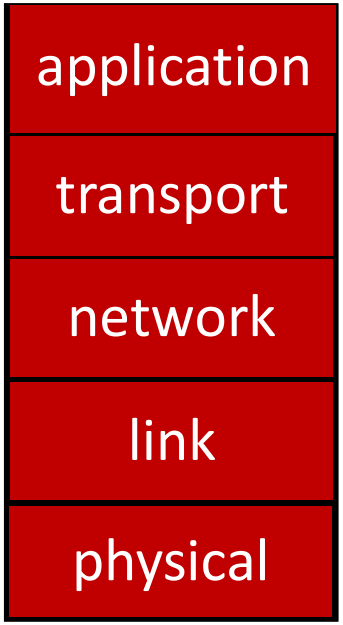
Why layering?

Approach to designing/discussing complex systems:

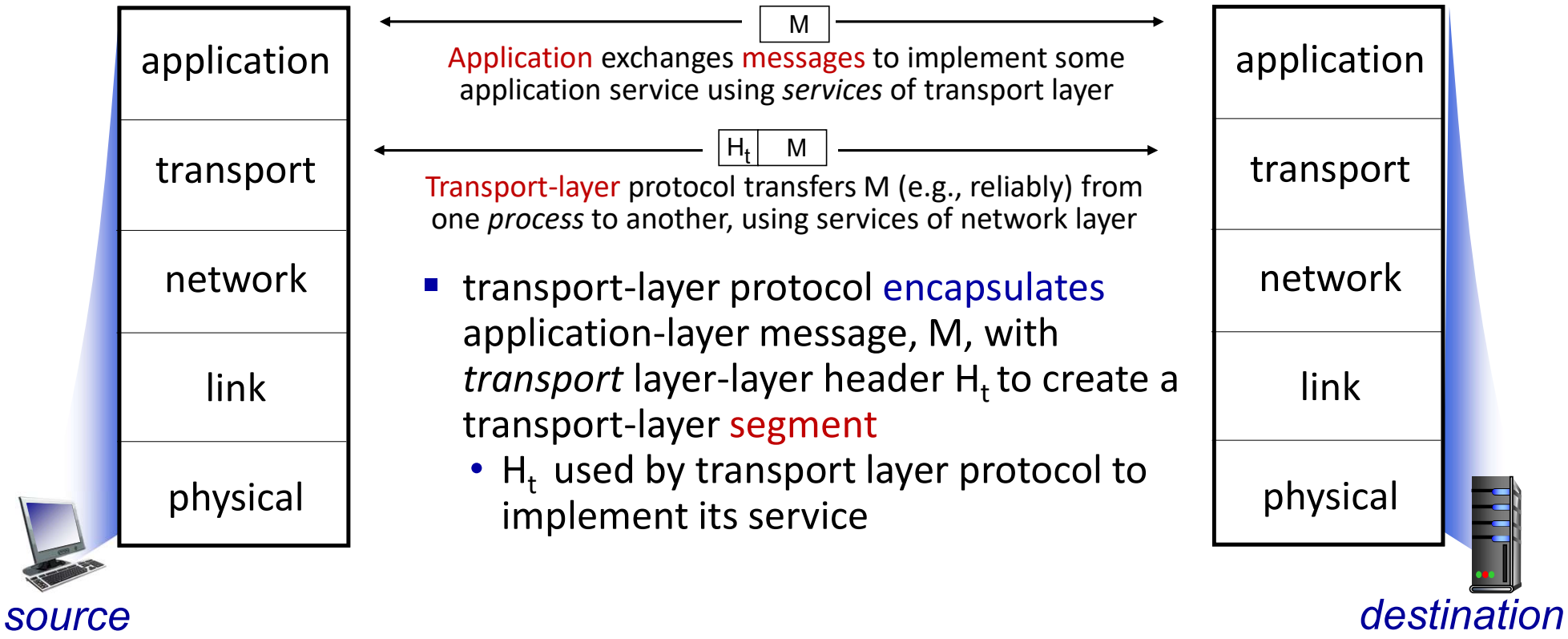
- explicit structure allows identification, relationship of system's pieces
  - layered *reference model* for discussion
- modularization eases maintenance, updating of system
  - change in layer's service *implementation*: transparent to rest of system
  - e.g., change in gate procedure doesn't affect rest of system

Layered Internet protocol stack

- *application:* supporting network applications
  - HTTP, IMAP, SMTP, DNS
- *transport:* process-process data transfer
  - TCP, UDP
- *network:* routing of datagrams from source to destination
  - IP, routing protocols
- *link:* data transfer between neighboring network elements
  - Ethernet, 802.11 (WiFi), PPP
- *physical:* bits “on the wire”

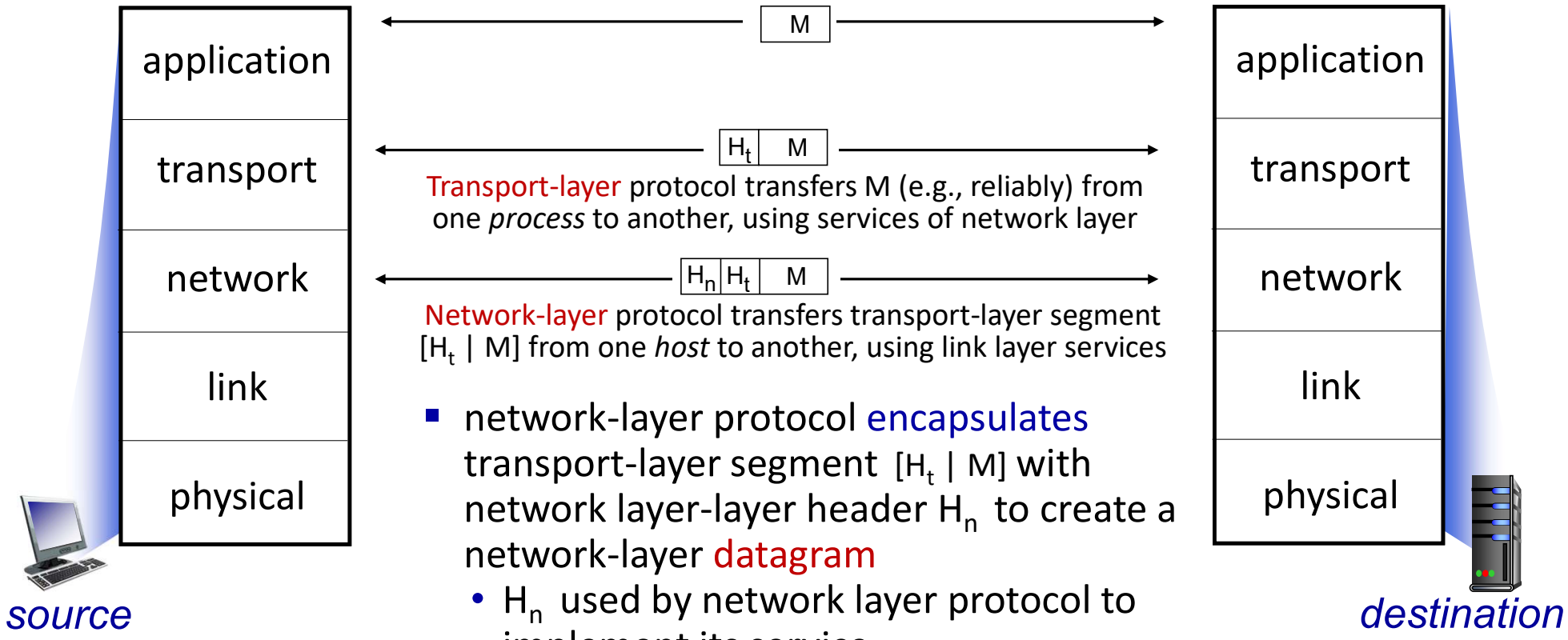


Services, Layering and Encapsulation



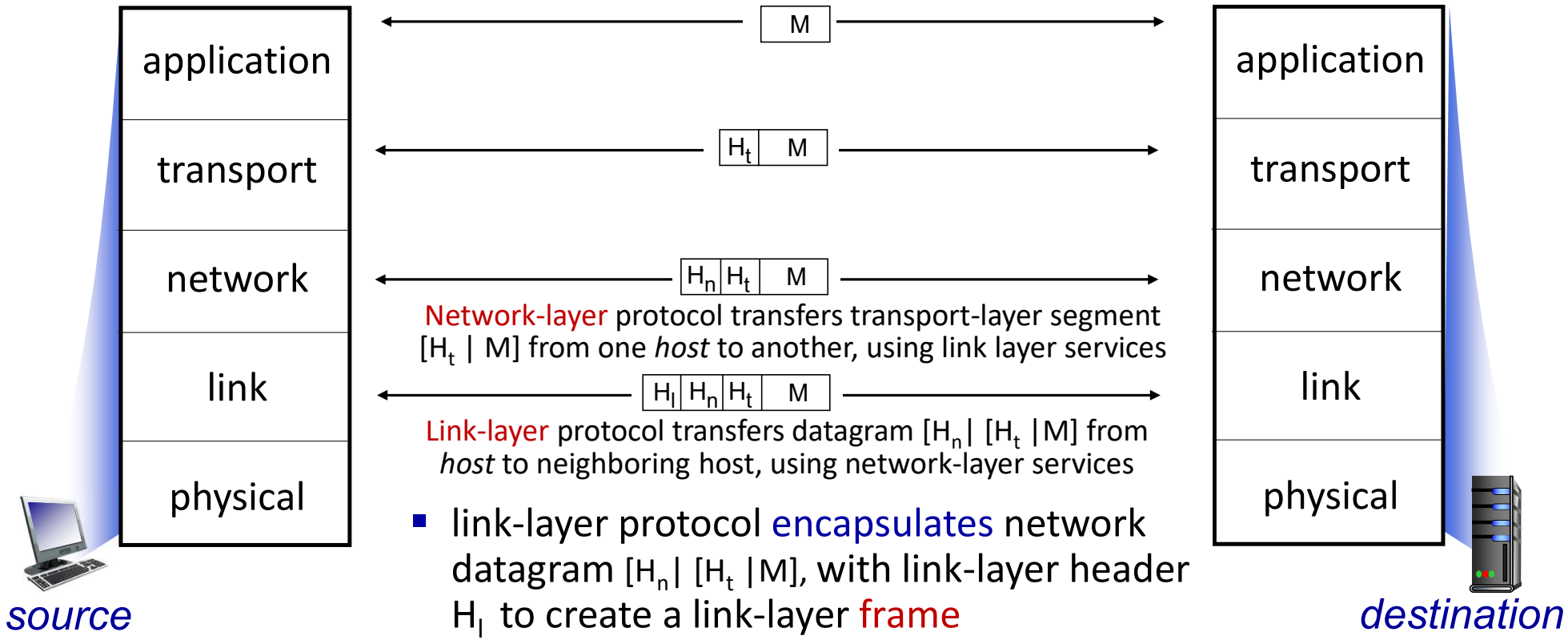
- transport-layer protocol encapsulates application-layer message, M, with *transport* layer-layer header H_t to create a transport-layer segment
  - H_t used by transport layer protocol to implement its service

Services, Layering and Encapsulation



- network-layer protocol encapsulates transport-layer segment [H_t | M] with network layer-layer header H_n to create a network-layer datagram
  - H_n used by network layer protocol to implement its service

Services, Layering and Encapsulation

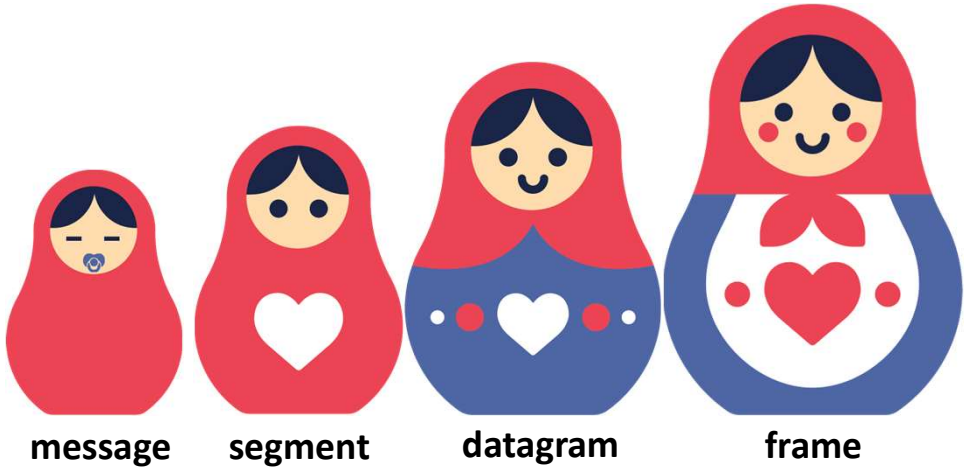


- link-layer protocol encapsulates network datagram [H_n| [H_t |M], with link-layer header H_l to create a link-layer frame

Encapsulation

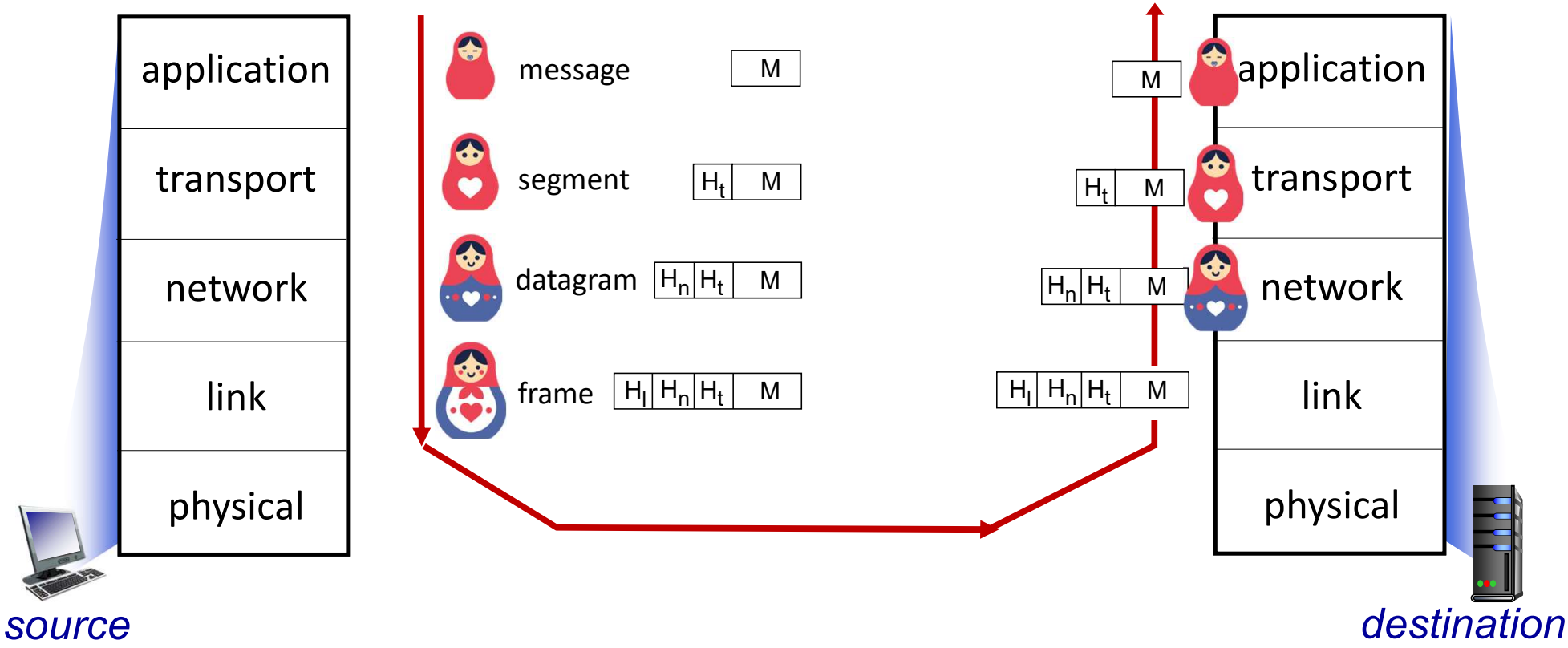
Matryoshka dolls (stacking dolls)





Credit: https://dribbble.com/shots/7182188-Babushka-Boi

Services, Layering and Encapsulation



Encapsulation: an end-end view

